



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2023-24
FINAL EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET B)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 10 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

Attempt all five questions.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- i) Write an original short story that begins with the words: "As Prerna turned the first page of the newspaper, her eyes fell on an announcement..."
- ii) You were to participate in an online competition through a Google Meet link which was sent to you. You were a little late in joining. Narrate the whole incident. Mention about the competition, why you were late, how you finally managed to join and perform. Also write about how you felt in that tense situation and what you learnt from this experience.
- iii) Imagine, one night you dreamt of an angel who gifted you with the power to read the minds of people for a day. The next day you met a shopkeeper, a young man sitting all alone in a park and your neighbour's boy who is mischievous and never wants to study. Write about when you met them and what was going on in their minds as you read them. Also mention how you felt as you read their minds.

- iv) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- i) In today's world of e-mail and SMS, you wish to go back to the conventional way of writing letters on paper. Write a letter to your grandmother telling her about this and the reason/s. Mention how you feel writing this letter to her and request her to reply to you in the same mode.
- ii) You wish to avail the school bus facility for pick-up and drop. Write a letter to the principal of your school with the above request mentioning the reason. Also furnish necessary location details, from when you wish to avail and finally request to let you know the monthly conveyance fee.

Question 3

- i) Your school is hosting an Inter-School Science Exhibition for the students of Classes VI to VIII to celebrate National Science Day. Write a notice for the school notice board informing students about the event and inviting them to participate. [5]
- ii) Write an e-mail to the Principal of a neighbouring school informing him/her about the Inter-School Science Exhibition and requesting him/her to send interested students from classes VI to VIII along with two teachers to participate in the exhibition. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

In the late spring of 1930, Philip Rhayader came to the abandoned lighthouse at the mouth of the river Aelder on the Essex coast. He was a painter of birds and of nature and had withdrawn from all human society. He was afflicted with a hunched back and a deformed, twisted hand. Although physical deformity often breeds abhorrence of humanity in people, Rhayader had no such feeling for anyone. His heart was filled with pity and understanding. He had mastered his handicap, but he could not master the predicament because of his appearance. The thing that drove him into seclusion was his failure to find anybody who loved him as much as he loved nature and humanity.

One November afternoon, three years after Rhayader had come to the Great Marsh, a child approached his lighthouse studio. In her arms, she carried a burden. She was slender, dirty, nervous and timid as a bird, but beneath the dirt, as beautiful as a fairy. She was desperately frightened of the ugly man she had come to see, but greater than her fear was the need of that which she carried. For locked in her child's heart was the knowledge picked up somewhere in the swamp-land, that this ogre who lived in the lighthouse had magic that could heal injured things.

She had never seen Rhayader before and was close to fleeing in panic at the dark apparition that appeared at the studio door, drawn by her footsteps the black head and beard, the sinisterness of the hump and the crooked hand, bent at the wrist. She stood there staring, poised like a disturbed marsh bird for instant flight. But his voice was deep and kind when he spoke to her. "What is it, child?"

She stood her ground, and then edged timidly forward. The thing she carried in her arms was a large white bird, and it was quite still. There were stains of blood on its whiteness and on her dress where she had held it to her.

The girl placed it in his arms carefully.

"I found it, sir. It is hurt. Is it still alive?"

"Yes. Yes, I think so. Come in, child, come in."

Rhayader went inside bearing the bird, which he placed upon a table, where it moved feebly. Curiosity overcame fear. The little girl followed and found herself in a room warmed by a coal fire, shining with many coloured pictures that covered the walls, and full of a strange but pleasant smell.

The bird fluttered. With his good right hand Rhayader carefully spread one of its immense white pinions. The end was beautifully tipped with black.

Rhayader looked and marvelled, and said, "It is a snow goose from Canada. But how in heaven

did it come here?"

The name seemed to mean nothing to the little girl. Her deep, violet eyes, shining out of the dirt on her thin face, were fixed with concern on the injured bird.

She said, "Can you heal it, sir?"

"Yes, yes," said Rhayader. "We will try. Come, you shall help me."

There were scissors and bandages and splints on a shelf, and he was marvellously deft, even with the crooked hand that managed to hold things.

He said, "Ah, she has been shot, poor thing. Her leg is broken, and the wing wounded, but not badly. We will bandage the wing closer to her body, so that she cannot move it until it has set, and then make a splint for the poor leg."

Her fears forgotten, the child watched with fascination, as he worked, and fixed a fine splint to the shattered leg after bandaging its wing.

"A bitter reception for a visiting princess," concluded Rhayader. "We will call her the Lost Princess. And in a few days, she will be feeling much better. See?"

He caressed it softly and reached into his pocket and produced a handful of grains. The snow goose opened its round yellow eyes and nibbled at it. The child laughed with delight.

i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided:

[2]

1. *apparition*

- a) tall man
- b) stranger
- c) shadow
- d) angel

2. *deft*

- a) caring
- b) skilful
- c) sluggish
- d) systematic

ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of the word 'sympathy'.

[1]

- a) predicament
- b) abhorrence
- c) sinisterness
- d) fascination

iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- a) Which sentence in the passage tells us that Philip Rhayader isolated himself from the rest of the world? [1]
- b) Describe the little girl. [2]
- c) What had happened to the snow goose? [2]
- d) How can we say that the little girl was worried about the bird? [2]
- e) Give a suitable title to this passage and justify. [2]

iv) In not more than 50 words, write all that Philip Rhayader did in nursing the bird. [8]

Question 5

i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the verb from the options given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example: (0) May [4]

__ (0) __ (May / Shall) I know whether you know driving? Well, I __ (1) __ (could, can) drive a car. You __ (2) __ (may, shall) not believe me. __ (3) __ (Should, Could) you lend me your car so that I __ (4) __ (can, might) show you? I __ (5) __ (should, might) as well take you on a ride if you wish. But remember, you __ (6) __ (shall, must) fasten your seat belt as per traffic rule. I am sure you __ (7) __ (may, will) finally accept that I know driving. I suggest, you too __ (8) __ (shall, should) learn driving.

ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate prepositions: [4]

- a) I have immense admiration _____ Swami Vivekananda.
- b) Do you know how much we can benefit _____ yoga?
- c) He is well capable _____ winning this tournament.
- d) There is a huge demand _____ leather jackets during winter.
- e) She was entrusted _____ the duty to take care of the child.
- f) Let's join hands and fight _____ social injustice.
- g) I shall remain ever grateful _____ you all.
- h) Please dispose _____ your food waste in proper container.

iii) Change the degree of the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. My room is cleaner than most other rooms in our house. (Change into Positive degree)
 - a) Few other room in our house is as clean as my room.
 - b) No other room in our house is as clean as my room.
 - c) Very few rooms in our house are cleaner than my room.
 - d) Very few rooms in our house are as clean as my room.
2. The Mahabharat is longer than any other epic. (End with:the Mahabharat.)
 - a) Very few epics are as long as the Mahabharat.
 - b) No other epic is as long as the Mahabharat.
 - c) Some epics are not as long as the Mahabharat.
 - d) Very few epics are less long than the Mahabharat.
3. Hercules was one of the strongest men. (Change the degree)
 - a) Hercules was stronger than any other man.
 - b) Very few men were as strong as Hercules.
 - c) Hercules was stronger than most other men.
 - d) No other man was as strong as Hercules.

4. No other child in this nursery is as pretty as she. (Use: prettier)

- a) Very few children in this nursery are prettier than she.**
- b) She is prettier than all other child.**
- c) She is prettier than all other child in this nursery.**
- d) She is prettier than any other child in this nursery.**

iv) Re-write the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. [8]

1. In spite of bad weather, he decided to go to the sea. (Rewrite as a compound sentence)

- a) The weather was bad yet he decided to go to the sea.**
- b) He decided to go to the sea and the weather was bad.**
- c) The weather was bad but it did not stop him from going to the sea.**
- d) Both a and c**

2. He is the culprit. I am not sure of it. (Join the two to make a complex sentence)

- a) I am not sure of him being the culprit.**
- b) He is the culprit and I am not sure.**
- c) I am not sure whether he is the culprit.**
- d) I am not sure of the fact that, he is the culprit.**

3. The match was cancelled because it was raining. (Rewrite as a simple sentence)

- a) Being raining, the match was cancelled.**
- b) The match was cancelled for it was raining.**
- c) The match was cancelled due to rain.**
- d) Rain cancel the match.**

4. He made ____ effort to understand the laws of ____ Euclidean geometry. (Fill in the blanks with suitable articles as necessary)

- a) He made an effort to understand the laws of Euclidean geometry.**
- b) He made an effort to understand the laws of an Euclidean geometry.**
- c) He made effort to understand the laws of the Euclidean geometry.**
- d) He made an effort to understand the laws of a Euclidean geometry.**

5. You might have ____ euphoric feeling after meeting ____ N.D.A. cadet. (Fill in the blanks with suitable articles as necessary)

- a) You might have an euphoric feeling after meeting an N.D.A. cadet.**
- b) You might have a euphoric feeling after meeting an N.D.A. cadet.**
- c) You might have the euphoric feeling after meeting a N.D.A. cadet.**
- d) You might have a euphoric feeling after meeting a N.D.A. cadet.**

6. The students have scored above 80%. They are eligible for the exam. (Join the two sentences using an adjective clause)
- a) The students are eligible for the exam since they have score above 80%.
 - b) The students scoring above 80% are eligible for the exam.
 - c) The students, scoring above 80%, are eligible for the exam.
 - d) The students, who have scored above 80%, are eligible for the exam.
7. I know which bag contains gold coins. (Underline and identify the clause)
- a) I know which bag contains gold coins. - Noun Clause
 - b) I know which bag contains gold coins. – Adjective Clause
 - c) I know which bag contains gold coins. - Adverb Clause
 - d) I know which bag contains gold coins. - Noun Clause
8. Since he did not come yesterday, he will be marked absent. (Underline and identify the clause)
- a) Since he did not come yesterday, he will be marked absent. -Noun Clause
 - b) Since he did not come yesterday, he will be marked absent. Adverb Clause
 - c) Since he did not come yesterday, he will be marked absent. – Adverb Clause
 - d) Since he did not come yesterday, he will be marked absent. - Adjective Clause